



Managing Change

Anticipating change and managing it successfully are key to running a business. Take a methodical approach, with clear steps, and you can adapt successfully to new business conditions.

Reasons for change

When you start a business, making any significant changes in the short to medium term may be the last thing on your mind. But external and internal factors can affect what your business offers at any time, so being able to adjust is essential.

For example, new technology or shifting consumer trends could lead to significant rises or falls in demand for your products or services. Alternatively, you might have to comply with new regulations in your industry, set by the government. Or, even more

unexpectedly, an environmental crisis could throw the markets into total chaos.

Planning for change

If you prepare in advance to handle change and put a logical process in place, you will be ready to adapt

Managing the change process

When a business is faced with change, it needs the support and enthusiasm of everyone involved to guarantee a positive outcome. For this to happen, it is important that you, as leader of the business, are open and transparent about why change is happening. Engaging staff, important clients, and any affected business associates, such as suppliers or investors, is also critical. If you actively involve them in the steps you take, they are more likely to support the changes required and contribute to a smooth development of the business.

ASSESS THE CHANGE

Identify the business goals that the change should deliver. Consider how quickly you will need to implement change, whether it will be gradual or sudden, and who it will affect.

OUTLINE THE PLAN

Set out a course of action. List what changes need to occur at each level of the business. Think about what points staff may be resistant to and how you will address these.

